STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	CS-3600

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 01/24/08	DATE REVISED **04/08/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE COURT SERVICES	RESOURCES CALEA 70.1.1, 70.1.2, 70.1.6, 70.1.7, 70.1.8
SUBJECT INMATE TRANSPORTATION	CROSS REFERENCE G-3310 ROAD PATROL UNIFORMS G-6300 AUTHORIZED RESTRAINTS G-6310 ELECTRONIC RESTRAINTS P-4710 TRANSPORTATION OF SUSPECTS P-4730 GUARDING HOSPITALIZED INMATES/ARRESTS

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for transportation of inmates by the Court Security and Transportation Unit.

II. Policy:

The Court Security and Transportation Unit shall have the primary responsibility for the transportation of inmates throughout the local area. The transportation of inmates by deputies shall be conducted in a lawful, professional, and orderly manner in order to ensure the safety and security of the general public, the inmate(s), and the transporting deputies. This policy shall apply to those inmates who are already in custody and not street arrests (see P-4710 Transportation of Suspects).

III. Procedure:

A. Transportation of Inmates-General:

1. All Sarpy County personnel assigned to the Court Security and Transportation Unit or Jail shall be in a regulation uniform while transporting inmates. This shall include duty belt and all required equipment (see G-3310 Road Patrol Uniforms). No civilian attire shall be worn unless approved by a command officer.

2. Deputies shall utilize the Sheriffs C.A.R.E channel for all radio communications regarding the transportation of inmates.

3. Prior to transport, no inmate shall be advised of his or her transportation date, time or destination.

4. Prior to placing an inmate into a transport vehicle, deputies shall search the inmate for contraband. It shall never be assumed that someone else has already searched an inmate.

5. Inmates shall be appropriately dressed for current weather conditions before being transported from any facility.

6. With vehicles so equipped, all inmates shall wear seatbelts during transportation.

7. While transporting inmates, the most reasonable and direct route shall be used.

8. The Security and Transportation Supervisor or his or her designee shall determine if there is a need to utilize an independent transportation company. In doing this the supervisor or designee shall determine the length of the transport, the risk factor of the inmate, and the medical condition of the inmate being transported. The Security and Transportation Supervisor or his or her designee will run a complete criminal history of the inmate and obtain a medical assessment of the inmate. Permission from the Court Services Captain shall be obtained for the use of an independent company. After permission from the Court Services Captain, the supervisor of the Security and Transportation Unit or his or her designee shall contact the facility holding the inmate for transport. The holding facility shall be notified of the date and time of the transport and who shall transport the inmate.

9. If a request is made by the Sarpy County Department of Corrections to transport an inmate to a hospital for an emergency procedure or other medical facility for a regularly scheduled appointment, he/she shall be a "high priority" prisoner as defined by P-4730 Guarding Hospitalized Inmates/Arrests.

B. Inmate/Deputy Requirements:

1. One (1) deputy may transport one (1) inmate in a vehicle equipped with a partition.

2. Two (2) deputies are required to transport two (2) or more inmates with the following exception.

a) One (1) deputy may transport two (2) or more inmates to or from the Hall of Justice to the Sarpy County Jail.

3. A female deputy or two (2) male deputies are required to transport a female inmate.

4. A female deputy shall always be present when a mentally incompetent female is transported.

5. Male and female inmates shall be separated as much as possible during transportation and shall never be secured together in a holding cell or left unsupervised in a transport vehicle.

C. Inmate Transportation-Court Security and Transportation Unit Supervisor:

1. The Security and Transportation Supervisor or his or her designee shall compile the daily transportation schedule and coordinate all local inmate transportation. Unscheduled transports shall be handled on an as-needed basis.

2. The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall determine if additional manpower or electronic restraints may be required to transport potentially dangerous inmates (see G-6310 Electronic Restraints).

3. The Security and Transportation Supervisor or his or her designee shall maintain the Transportation Daily Log.

D. Prior to Transportation-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Deputies shall verify all warrants by telephone or teletype prior to departure.

2. Deputies shall attempt to identify potentially dangerous inmates (e.g., inmates with a history of escape or history of felony crimes of violence) prior to transport. If a deputy believes an inmate may require additional security measures, he or she shall notify the Security and Transportation Supervisor.

a) If the inmate is being transported to court, the deputy shall notify the judge of the potential risk.

b) If the inmate is being transported to another facility, the receiving facility shall be notified of the potential risk.

3. Deputies shall inspect the transport vehicle prior to transport. This shall include searching the interior for contraband and inspecting the entire vehicle for damage. Deputies shall document any new damage or irregularities and shall advise the Security and Transportation Supervisor.

4. If the transport will take the deputy(s) outside of the range of Sarpy County Communications, he or she shall ensure the Security and Transportation Supervisor has been advised of their personal phone number.

5. Generally, inmates shall be properly restrained with a leather or chain transport belt, handcuffs and leg shackles and shall be searched prior to being placed in the transport vehicle. Alternate approved restraints may be used with approval of the Security and Transportation Supervisor (see G-6300 Authorized Restraints).

6. Communications shall be advised of the following:

a) The serial numbers of all transporting deputies.
b) The transport vehicle's identification number.
c) The number of and gender of the inmates.
d) The destination.

E. Transportation of Inmates-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Inmates shall always remain under observation.

2. Deputies shall avoid responding to incidents while transporting inmates unless their actions are immediately necessary to prevent death or serious bodily injury. If a law violation is witnessed or a motorist is in need of assistance, Communications shall be notified to dispatch the appropriate personnel.

F. Arrival at Destination- Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Deputies shall secure their weapons prior to entering a jail facility or any other facility that does not allow weapons. Weapons shall be placed in lock boxes provided by the facility or in the transport vehicle lock box.

2. Restraints shall remain on the inmate until removal is authorized by the receiving facility personnel.

3. All required documentation shall be provided to the receiving facility prior to the deputy leaving.

4. Deputies shall advise the receiving facility personnel of any potential medical, mental illness, or security issues associated with the inmate.

5. Deputies shall obtain all available documentation confirming the transfer of custody.

6. Deputies shall search the interior of the transport vehicle for contraband and/or damage after the transport is complete.

G. Emergency During Transport-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. In the event of mechanical failure during the transportation of an inmate(s), the deputy shall notify the Security and Transportation Supervisor to determine if an additional transport vehicle is available to take custody of the inmate(s).

a) If an additional transport vehicle is not immediately available, Communications shall be notified to dispatch the nearest available road patrol unit to take custody of the inmate(s).

b) The inmate(s) shall not be allowed outside of the transport vehicle until the additional transport vehicle or patrol unit has arrived unless remaining in the vehicle endangers the inmate(s) (e.g. vehicle is on fire).

c) If possible, a deputy shall remain with the disabled transport vehicle until the repair or tow is completed.

2. In the event of a medical emergency during the transportation of an inmate(s), the deputies shall stop the transport vehicle in a safe location and notify Communications. A rescue squad and a patrol unit shall be requested.

a) If more than one (1) inmate is being transported, a deputy shall accompany the inmate in the rescue squad and a second deputy shall continue the transportation of the remaining inmates.

b) If a second deputy is not available, the responding road patrol unit shall be requested to take custody of the remaining inmates and the transport deputy shall accompany the inmate in the rescue squad. The transport vehicle may be secured and recovered at a later time.

3. In the event the emergency occurs outside of Sarpy County, the transport deputy(s) shall request assistance from the nearest law enforcement agency using a cellular phone. A Sarpy County deputy shall remain with any inmates until they are secured in a detention facility. The Security and Transportation Supervisor shall be notified as soon as possible.

H. Escape of Inmate During Transport-Deputy Responsibilities: In the event of an escape during transport, deputies shall:

1. Immediately notify Communications and provide all necessary information. If outside of Sarpy County, the deputy shall notify the nearest law enforcement agency.

2. Take appropriate action to recover the inmate. If multiple inmates are being transported, a deputy shall remain with any inmates who have not escaped and if a second deputy is available, he or she may attempt to apprehend the escaped inmate.

3. Notify the Security and Transportation Supervisor.

4. All involved deputies shall complete a detailed incident report regarding any escape from custody.